

Hreidmar, as was the custom at the time, demanded compensation for the murder of his son. He made a bag from Otr's skin. "Fill this with gold and I'll consider the debt repaid," he growled. "Fail, and I'll kill you all."

This whole mess being Loki's fault, the gods agreed that he should be the one to find the gold. Loki set out to seek a wealthy dwarf called Andvari, and found him swimming in fish-form.

"Give me every ounce of your gold," demanded Loki, holding Andvari by the fin. "Or I'll carve you open from head to tail."

As Loki staggered away with the treasure, the furious dwarf cried, "Death will befall any who possess that gold!"

"No problem," Loki muttered. "I won't be keeping it."

As soon as the gods had paid their debt, they returned – with much relief – to Asgard.

Fafnir took one look at the gold before striking his father dead and throwing his brother Regin out onto the road.

"This treasure is mine," he roared, transforming himself into a monstrous dragon. "And no one shall take it from me!"



*Fafnir turned into a monstrous dragon.*